

Impact High · Difficulty Easy · Misuse risk It fails when you perform attention as a display - holding eye contact too long, anno

THE MOVE

Pause the competing task + orient warmly + clear the distraction + one readiness line + listen through. -> Hang on, let me put this down. I want to actually hear this. -> Go on, I'm with you. -> Let me close this so I'm not half-listening. -> You have...

START HERE

Phone away, body toward them, and: "Go on, I'm with you."

SAY THIS

Quick defaults	"Go on, I'm with you."
Warm and human	"Hang on, let me put this away. I want to actually hear this."
Social / dating	"Okay, that sounds like the real story."
Professional / leader...	"Let me close this laptop so I can focus."
High-status / busy pe...	"I'll be concise. What's the key thing you need me to understand?"
Digital / text	"I want to reply properly, not quickly. I'll come back to this tonight."

AVOID

- They are shy, anxious, culturally uncomfortable with direct eye contact, or clearly need more space.
- The situation calls for lightness, movement or parallel activity rather than intense face-to-face focus.
- You would only be performing focus to look attentive, not to actually listen better.

REMEMBER

Attention is only credible once your behaviour removes what is competing for it.